COST TEARDOWN · 5-PERSON AGENCY

$2,310

per month, before

The same agency, rebuilt for $47 a month.

Five swaps. Two are free, three are cheap. Nothing stopped working.

$47

per month, after

SWAP 1 · CRM

THEY PAY

HubSpot Starter, 5 seats

~~$90~~

per month

SWAP TO

Twenty (open source)

$0

per month

YOU KEEP

- ✓ Pipelines, contacts, tasks
- ✓ Email sync, CSV import
- ✓ Unlimited seats

YOU GIVE UP

- – Hosted uptime (self-host or $6 VPS)
- – Marketing automation suite

Save $1,080 / yr

Run a tight ship. Spend on what matters.

swipe →

SWAP 2 · SUPPORT INBOX

THEY PAY

Intercom Essential

~~$390~~

per month

SWAP TO

Chatwoot

$0

per month

YOU KEEP

- ✓ Website chat, WhatsApp, Instagram, email
- ✓ AI agent trained on your docs
- ✓ Canned replies, SLAs, reports

YOU GIVE UP

- – Intercom's product tours
- – Fin AI resolution pricing model

Save $4,680 / yr

SWAP 3 · FORMS

THEY PAY

Typeform Plus

~~$59~~

per month

SWAP TO

Tally Pro

$29

per month

YOU KEEP

- ✓ Unlimited forms and responses
- ✓ Logic, payments, file uploads
- ✓ Notion-style editor

YOU GIVE UP

- – Typeform's video questions

Save $360 / yr

SIDE BY SIDE

Monthly cost, before and after each swap

CRM

$90 HubSpot
$0 Twenty

Support inbox

$390 Intercom
$0 Chatwoot

Forms

$59 Typeform
$29 Tally

Team AI chat, 5 seats

$150 ChatGPT Team
$12 Open WebUI + API

Cloud hosting

$1,621 AWS on-demand
$6 Hetzner VPS

Hosting is the quiet killer. One $6 VPS runs the CRM, the inbox and the AI chat for a 5-person team.

WHAT YOU ACTUALLY LOSE

Feature check: Intercom vs Chatwoot

	Intercom	Chatwoot
Shared inbox	✓	✓
WhatsApp + Instagram	✓	✓
AI answers from docs	✓	✓
Help centre	✓	✓
Product tours	✓	–
Per-seat pricing	✓	–
Self-host option	–	✓

If you do not run product tours, you are paying $390 a month for a logo.

THE NUMBER

98%

of this agency's software bill disappeared. $2,263 a month, back in the business.

Vendor list prices, Nov 2026. Hosting at Hetzner CX22.

DO IT THIS WEEKEND

Four steps, one afternoon

01 Rent one small VPS (Hetzner CX22 or similar, about $6/mo).

02 Install Docker and start Twenty.

```
git clone twentyhq/twenty && make up
```

03 Start Chatwoot on the same box.

```
docker compose up -d
```

04 Point your domain, import HubSpot CSV, add the chat widget. Cancel the old tools next month.

Time: 3 to 4 hours. Skills: copy and paste.

RECAP

The $47 stack

Twenty — $0
replaces HubSpot Starter

Chatwoot — $0
replaces Intercom Essential

Tally Pro — $29
replaces Typeform Plus

Open WebUI + API credits — $12
replaces ChatGPT Team

Hetzner VPS — $6
replaces AWS on-demand

Run a tight ship. Spend on what matters.

swipe →

WHY THIS WORKS



Most small businesses do not have a software problem. They have a pricing-page problem.

— Frugal Ops

One swap a day. Free when possible, cheap when not.

Save this. Send it to whoever approves the software budget. Repo and pricing links in the first comment.

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